CORE FALSE BELIEF #14 · THE WORLD & THE FUTURE

"Things will always go badly."

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Where it often comes from

This belief often follows a long run of hardship: repeated losses, chronic illness, financial struggles, or a childhood where good things rarely lasted. When disappointment comes again and again, the mind learns to expect it, partly to avoid being caught off guard. Over time hopelessness can feel like realism, and good things get dismissed as flukes.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture does not deny that life brings trouble, but it insists that trouble is not the final word. God told His people in exile that He had plans to give them a future and a hope. Weeping may stay the night, but joy comes in the morning. God promises to do new things, even making a way in the wilderness. Paul wrote that God works all things together for the good of those who love Him. Bad seasons are real, but they are seasons, and God is at work in them.

> *"For I know the plans I have for you, declares the LORD, plans to prosper you and not to harm you, to give you a future and a hope"* (Jeremiah 29:11).

Also see

> "And we know that God works all things together for the good of those who love Him, who are called according to His purpose" (Romans 8:28).

> "Because of the loving devotion of the LORD we are not consumed, for His mercies never fail. They are new every morning; great is Your faithfulness!" (Lamentations 3:22–23).

> "For His anger is fleeting, but His favor lasts a lifetime. Weeping may stay the night, but joy comes in the morning" (Psalm 30:5).

> "Behold, I am about to do something new; even now it is coming. Do you not see it? Indeed, I will make a way in the wilderness and streams in the desert" (Isaiah 43:19).

Common self-statements

- Nothing ever works out for me.
- As soon as things get better, something will ruin it.
- Why hope? It never turns out.
- My life is just one bad thing after another.
- Good things don't last.
- It will always be like this.

Common logical errors

- Fortune telling: Predicting that the future will be as bad as the past.
- Overgeneralization: Using "always" and "never" about my life.
- Mental filter: Seeing only what goes wrong and overlooking what goes right.
- Discounting the positive: Calling good things luck or temporary.

Challenging questions

- Is it true that things always go badly, or only often?

- What has gone well, even in small ways, this past year?
- What season of my life was better than I expected?
- What does God say about my future?
- Am I protecting myself from disappointment by expecting the worst?
- What would hope look like today?

Truth summary

> I have been through many hard things, and more may come. But "always" is not true. Good things have happened, and God has promised a future and a hope. Hard seasons do not last forever, and God is at work even now.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Hopeless
- Hardship
- Plans
- Thinking, Healthy
- Joy

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Trouble/Hardship
- Depression

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Glorious Unfolding — Steven Curtis Chapman
God's story continues beyond a painful or confusing chapter.

All Things New — Steven Curtis Chapman
God's renewing work offers hope beyond failure, decay, and loss.

Even If — MercyMe
Trust in God need not depend on receiving the particular miracle we want.

Because He Lives — Bill and Gloria Gaither
This older favorite grounds courage for tomorrow in Christ's resurrection.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "Things will always go badly"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Things will always go badly." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Is it true things always go badly?
- ☐ What has gone well this year?
- ☐ When was life better than I expected?
- ☐ What does God say about my future?
- ☐ Am I expecting the worst to protect myself?
- ☐ What would hope look like today?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God has plans to give me a future and a hope.
- ☐ Joy comes in the morning.
- ☐ His mercies are new every morning.
- ☐ Hard seasons are seasons.
- ☐ God is doing something new.
- ☐ Good things are real, not just luck.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Jeremiah 29:11**
  "For I know the plans I have for you, declares the LORD, plans to prosper you and not to harm you, to give you a future and a hope."
- ☐ **Psalm 30:5**
  "For His anger is fleeting, but His favor lasts a lifetime. Weeping may stay the night, but joy comes in the morning."
- ☐ **Isaiah 43:19**
  "Behold, I am about to do something new; even now it is coming. Do you not see it? Indeed, I will make a way in the wilderness and streams in the desert."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] What went right today: Each evening, write three things that went right today, even small ones.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Jeremiah 29:11 becomes: "Tom can write: "God knows the plans He has for me. He is giving me a future and a hope.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Hopeless" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If this belief comes with hopelessness or thoughts of ending your life, call or text 988 (the Suicide & Crisis Lifeline), or call 911 in an emergency. You do not have to carry this alone.

- [ ] Keep a "good things" journal. Each night for two weeks, write three good things that happened. Read the whole list at the end.
- [ ] Remember a turnaround. Write about a time something you dreaded turned out better than expected.
- [ ] Plan one good thing. Schedule one small thing you can look forward to this week.
- [ ] Get help for lasting hopelessness. If hopelessness is heavy or constant, talk with a doctor, pastor, or counselor.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Things will always go badly": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Something that went right
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Things will always go badly.~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I have come to expect the worst. Thank You that You have plans to give me a future and a hope. Open my eyes to the good You are doing, and give me hope for tomorrow. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.